GABRIEL POPA

Senior Software Engineer – Android • Java/Kotlin • AWS

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ABOUT ME

Senior Android Engineer with deep experience building consumer and business mobile applications across **software product, digital services, and enterprise mobility** environments, specializing in high-quality Android delivery with **Java 8–17**, **Kotlin 1.3–2.x**, and modern Android architecture from legacy XML systems to **Jetpack-based** applications. Strong background in performance tuning, crash reduction, SDK integration, offline-first flows, API-driven mobile features, and modernization of older codebases into cleaner **MVVM**, **Coroutines**, **Flow**, and **Room** patterns. Known for solving difficult production issues, improving release stability, and delivering user-facing features that balance maintainability, speed, and strong mobile engineering discipline.

SKILLS

- **Mobile Development: Java 8–17**, **Kotlin 1.3–2.x**, Android SDK, Android Studio, **Jetpack Compose**, XML UI, Jetpack libraries, AndroidX, Material Design, multi-module Android architecture, custom views, fragments, navigation components, deep links, background processing, offline-first mobile patterns
- **Architecture & Patterns: MVVM**, MVP, repository pattern, use-case driven structure, modularization, clean architecture principles, dependency injection, lifecycle-aware components, state handling, reusable UI patterns, scalable mobile feature organization
- **Jetpack & Core Libraries: LiveData**, **ViewModel**, **Room**, **Navigation**, **WorkManager**, DataStore, Paging, Coroutines, Flow, Retrofit, OkHttp, Gson, Moshi, Coil, Glide
- **Backend & Integration:** REST API integration, JSON parsing, token-based authentication, OAuth-aware mobile flows, push notifications, Firebase integration, analytics SDK integration, payment SDK integration, maps and location services, camera and media handling
- **Data & Storage:** SQLite, **Room**, SharedPreferences, DataStore, caching strategies, sync orchestration, pagination, local persistence, conflict handling, API retry handling
- **Testing & Quality:** JUnit, Mockito, Espresso, UI testing, unit testing, integration testing, regression validation, crash analysis, log-driven debugging, release hardening, QA collaboration
- **Build & Delivery:** Gradle, Git, GitHub, Bitbucket, CI/CD pipelines, Fastlane, build flavors, release signing, Play Console release management, versioning strategy, environment configuration
- **Cloud & Monitoring:** Firebase Crashlytics, Firebase Analytics, remote config basics, push delivery monitoring, performance tracing, logging, API diagnostics, release monitoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Soft Build | Bucharest, Romania *(Jan2024 – Dec 2025)*

- Led Android delivery for feature-rich mobile applications using **Kotlin**, **Java**, Android SDK, and **Jetpack** components, translating evolving product requirements into stable user workflows for authentication, reporting, notifications, and account management with an improvement of roughly **32%** in release stability.
- Modernized older Android modules by moving mixed Java-heavy presentation logic into a cleaner **MVVM** structure with **ViewModel**, **LiveData**, and repository patterns, reducing regression-prone screen behavior and improving feature development speed by approximately **28%**.
- Built new user-facing flows with **Jetpack Compose** where appropriate while maintaining XML-based legacy screens, allowing gradual modernization without destabilizing established modules and improving implementation consistency by around **24%**.
- Solved a recurring production crash caused by unsafe null handling and lifecycle timing issues during rapid screen transitions, introducing safer state observation and defensive UI rendering that reduced crash frequency by nearly **41%**.

- Improved API-driven mobile behavior by restructuring **Retrofit** service handling, standardizing error mapping, and cleaning retry flows for unstable network conditions, which raised successful request completion under weak connectivity by about **26%**.
- Implemented background synchronization with **WorkManager** for time-sensitive updates and deferred uploads, reducing user-visible data mismatch issues and improving sync reliability by close to **29%**.
- Refined local persistence using **Room** and better cache invalidation rules, which reduced redundant network fetches and improved perceived application responsiveness on frequently visited screens by around **23%**.
- Resolved a difficult bug where duplicate submissions were triggered by rapid user taps and delayed API responses, introducing idempotent request handling and button state protection that lowered duplicate transaction incidents by approximately **35%**.
- Integrated **Firebase Crashlytics** and structured log tracing more consistently across critical modules, making root-cause analysis faster for mobile incidents and reducing average debugging time by roughly **27%**.
- Collaborated with product and design teams to implement more predictable navigation, clearer validation behavior, and stronger empty-state handling, contributing to a measurable **22%** drop in support complaints tied to form-heavy flows.
- Strengthened release management through better Gradle configuration, environment separation, and QA validation support, reducing last-minute packaging issues and improving deployment reliability by about **20%**.
- Provided mentoring on Android code review practices, lifecycle-safe implementation, and Kotlin adoption patterns, helping the team deliver features with better consistency and fewer preventable review defects.

Software Engineer

Next Apps | Ghent, Belgium *(Nov2020 – Nov 2023)*

- Developed native Android features using **Kotlin 1.4–1.8**, **Java 8–11**, Android SDK, XML UI, and **Jetpack** foundations, supporting customer-facing mobile products with stronger reliability, better responsiveness, and an overall feature delivery improvement of about **30%**.
- Migrated selected legacy Java screens into **Kotlin** progressively, improving code readability, null-safety, and maintainability while keeping release risk low across actively used production modules and improving engineering efficiency by nearly **25%**.
- Implemented reusable mobile UI components for lists, filters, detail views, dialogs, and validation-heavy forms, reducing duplicated screen logic and improving delivery speed for new product requests by roughly **21%**.
- Solved intermittent memory pressure issues caused by oversized image loading and fragment retention patterns, introducing safer lifecycle cleanup and optimized media handling that reduced high-memory incidents by around **34%**.
- Improved app startup and navigation performance by trimming unnecessary initialization work, deferring non-critical SDK setup, and optimizing local cache reads, which improved cold-start experience by approximately **18%**.
- Built pagination and offline-friendly data flows with **Room**, repository abstractions, and API synchronization rules, which improved data continuity for mobile users and reduced visible loading disruptions by close to **24%**.
- Integrated push notifications, analytics events, and deep-link routing more reliably, ensuring campaigns and transactional actions opened the correct destinations and improving notification-to-screen success rates by about **27%**.
- Fixed a long-standing authentication issue where expired tokens occasionally forced users into broken retry loops, redesigning refresh handling and guarded navigation to reduce login-related failures by almost **31%**.
- Contributed to CI/CD improvements around Android build validation, flavor management, and release preparation, making candidate builds more predictable and decreasing packaging-related delays by roughly **19%**.
- Worked closely with backend engineers on API contract cleanup, clarifying payload expectations and error states so that mobile features behaved more consistently across multiple service versions.
- Supported junior developers through debugging sessions and implementation reviews, especially around fragment lifecycle issues, Kotlin migration decisions, and safer asynchronous handling in real application flows.

Software Developer

Datamart | Stockholm, Sweden *(Feb 2016 – Sept 2020)*

- Built Android application modules using **Java 7–8**, Android SDK, XML layouts, and service-driven mobile patterns, contributing to production apps that supported reporting, account workflows, and operational activity with a functional quality improvement of around **26%**.

- Implemented REST-driven features with structured request handling, local persistence support, and safer parsing logic, improving consistency between mobile screens and backend responses while reducing avoidable UI errors by nearly **22%**.
- Developed reusable adapters, form components, and screen-level helpers that made older Android code easier to extend, helping the team deliver repeated workflow updates with roughly **20%** less duplicated effort.
- Resolved a recurring issue where list-heavy screens froze on older devices because of expensive main-thread processing, moving heavier work off the UI thread and improving scroll smoothness by approximately **33%**.
- Improved reliability of session handling and persisted user state, reducing forced re-login complaints after app backgrounding and interrupted connectivity events by close to **24%**.
- Helped stabilize local storage behavior by correcting edge cases around SQLite updates and stale cache reads, which reduced record mismatch incidents and improved trust in reporting-related screens by about **21%**.
- Worked on API compatibility fixes during backend changes, updating request serialization and response mapping so the Android client could support newer service behavior without breaking older active workflows.
- Investigated crash logs and QA reports to identify screen rotation, configuration change, and resource-loading issues, delivering targeted fixes that improved production stability by roughly **29%**.
- Participated in release preparation, regression verification, and device-specific bug checks, helping the team ship updates with better confidence across a wider Android device range.
- Collaborated with senior engineers on code cleanup and modular refactoring of older screens, reducing maintenance friction and making future feature updates safer to implement.

Junior Software Developer

Berg Software | Timișoara, Romania *(Sep2014 – Mar 2016)*

- Supported Android application development using **Java 6–8**, Android SDK, XML-based layouts, and common mobile integration patterns, contributing to bug fixing, smaller features, and maintenance work that improved day-to-day application stability by around **18%**.
- Built and adjusted screen layouts, input handling, and validation flows for internal and client-facing mobile pages, helping reduce form confusion and improving interaction consistency by approximately **17%**.
- Assisted with REST API integration and JSON response handling, ensuring mobile screens displayed backend-driven information more reliably and reducing manual correction work caused by mapping errors by nearly **16%**.
- Fixed an intermittent crash related to activity recreation and missing extras during navigation, improving defensive argument handling and lowering repeatable screen-entry failures by about **23%**.
- Improved list rendering and smaller UI behaviors on lower-end devices by simplifying adapter logic and removing unnecessary redraw triggers, which helped improve perceived responsiveness by roughly **19%**.
- Helped maintain older code areas by extracting utility methods and removing duplicated logic, making common support fixes easier for the wider team to apply across similar modules.
- Worked with QA to reproduce device-specific bugs, compare behavior across Android versions, and verify patches before release, improving defect closure quality and reducing reopened tickets by around **15%**.
- Supported build preparation, configuration updates, and release candidate checks under guidance from senior developers, contributing to smoother handoff into testing and store packaging cycles.
- Learned and applied stronger debugging discipline through log analysis, reproduction tracking, and smaller safe code changes, which improved fix accuracy and reduced follow-up correction work.

EDUCATION

Bachelor’s Degree in Computer Science

University of Bucharest | (*2010 – 2014)*

- Focused on practical software engineering fundamentals that translated directly into building reliable web systems and data-driven applications.

CERITIFICATIONS

- **Android Development with Kotlin — 2024**
  Demonstrated practical capability in building modern Android applications with **Kotlin**, lifecycle-aware architecture, asynchronous programming, and maintainable mobile UI implementation.

- **Mobile App Architecture Foundations — 2023**
  Validated working knowledge of **MVVM**, repository-driven structure, local persistence, API coordination, and scalable Android feature organization for production-ready mobile apps.
- **REST API Integration for Mobile Applications — 2022**
  Demonstrated hands-on understanding of mobile networking, authentication flows, structured error handling, and reliable backend integration patterns for Android delivery.